

Kefas Manda

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Full-stack software developer with production experience across fintech, product engineering, backend systems, cloud infrastructure, and data workflows. Strongest in React, TypeScript, Java, Spring Boot, SQL, REST APIs, PostgreSQL, BigQuery, and GCP. Currently building AI-assisted product workflows, custom MCP servers, and tool-calling AI assistants. Interested in AI-native software, reliability, testing, and 0-to-1 product engineering.

EDUCATION

Stellenbosch University <i>BSc Computer Science (focal area Computer Systems)</i>	Stellenbosch, WC <i>Graduation Date: Dec 2026</i>
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TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages: TypeScript, JavaScript, Java, SQL, Python, C, C++
Frontend: React, Next.js, TanStack Query, TanStack Router, TanStack Table
Backend: Spring Boot, REST APIs, Webhooks, WebSockets, Auth0, PayFast, SendGrid, Resend
Data&Cloud: PostgreSQL, MySQL, BigQuery, Google Cloud Platform, Cloud Run, Railway, Terraform, Git
AI&Tooling: LLMs, AI agents, custom MCP servers, tool calling, AI-assisted development workflows

WORK EXPERIENCE

Schoolscape <i>Software Developer, Independent Contractor:</i>	Stellenbosch, WC <i>Jun 2026 - Present</i>
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Tech Stack: Python, SQL, TypeScript (React), HTML/CSS, Zoho CRM, Zoho Forms, WordPress

- Designed, coded, and deployed custom event landing pages with Zoho Forms integrations for registration and lead capture
- Built Python-based data cleaning and matching workflows for large Zoho CRM account, contact, school, and domain datasets
- Identified duplicate records, incorrect account links, test data, bad inputs, and merge candidates across 60,000+ CRM records
- Improved CRM data quality using structured validation outputs and external school reference data

Glyde Payments (FinTech) <i>Software Developer</i>	Cape Town, WC <i>Jan 2025 - Feb 2026</i>
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Tech stack: Java, TypeScript, React, TanStack (Query, Router, Table), SQL, PostgreSQL, BigQuery, Python, Google Cloud Platform (Cloud Run), REST APIs, Webhooks, Terraform, SendGrid

- Designed and implemented an OFX export feature enabling direct import into QuickBooks, Xero, and Sage; later adopted commercially as a paid account capability.
- Migrated the Reporting module from a legacy frontend to a TanStack-based architecture.
- Built backend data export pipelines for financial statement generation.
- Contributed to REST APIs, webhook-based integrations, and backend services.
- Built and maintained BigQuery data warehousing pipelines.
- Developed SQL reporting workflows and transaction monitoring logic using PostgreSQL and BigQuery.
- Operated within GCP infrastructure including Cloud Run, BigQuery, and managed PostgreSQL.
- Mentored and onboarded junior engineers while delivering structured handover documentation across product and data systems.

Metacom <i>Embedded Systems Intern</i>	Cape Town, WC <i>Jun 2024 - Jul 2024</i>
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Tech Stack: C, C++, MQTT, ESP32

- Developed ESP32 firmware components deployed in a production networking environment.
- Worked with ESP32 microcontrollers and Arduino-based tooling
- Integrated MQTT for device communication

- Implemented HTTP client functionality on-device to communicate with server infrastructure
- Enabled remote firmware update capability via HTTP calls
- Feature deployed to production, improving firmware update efficiency and device performance

PROJECT EXPERIENCE

FineApp - Creative Freelance Platform

Stellenbosch, WC

Founder-led Platform Engineer

May 2025 - Present

Tech stack: Spring Boot (Java), Next.js, React, MySQL, Auth0, Cloudinary, Railway, PayFast, WebSockets, Resend

- Designed and built an end-to-end full-stack marketplace using Spring Boot, Next.js, and MySQL.
- Implemented secure REST APIs with role-based access control and Auth0 authentication.
- Integrated PayFast payments with verified webhook processing.
- Built real-time moderated chat, booking workflows, and booking state management.
- Deployed and maintained production infrastructure on Railway.
- Replaced manual email and WhatsApp coordination with automated booking and payment workflows, doubling creative onboarding from 15 to 30+ creatives.

Custom MCP Servers - AI Tooling Projects

- Built custom MCP servers exposing real application context and external tools to AI clients.
- Developed beacon-mcp to turn weather, commute, Gmail, Calendar, and FineApp admin data into agent-usable tools.
- Built jobmatch-mcp for job discovery and candidate-job ranking using profile-based matching.
- Built fineapp-mcp to expose FineApp creatives, profiles, search, and session packages to AI clients.

Showcased - Website Builder

Founder-led Full-Stack Product Engineer

Tech stack: Next.js, TypeScript, Supabase, Cloudflare R2, AI-assisted development workflows

- Building a full-stack website builder focused on reusable template systems, image-led website generation, and product-quality frontend architecture.
- Designed reusable section and template architecture for generating production-ready website layouts.
- Used AI-assisted workflows to accelerate product iteration, template generation, design exploration, and frontend implementation.
- Owned product decisions across UX, frontend architecture, data modelling, media workflows, and deployment.

More projects: kefas.co.za

Spatial Edge Data Hackathon

Stellenbosch, WC

2nd Place

Aug 2024 - Aug 2024

- Built an anomaly detection and predictive analytics solution using GCP datasets under time constraints.